

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, windy, colder, partly cloudy, high 35. **Tonight**, cloudy, a bit of snow late, low 33. **Tomorrow**, cloudy, some rain and snow, high 41. Weather map appears on Page B12.

VOL. CLXXV No. 60,766

© 2026 The New York Times Company

FRIDAY, JANUARY 16, 2026

Prices in Canada may be higher

\$4.00



Federal agents on Wednesday night in the Minneapolis neighborhood where an agent shot a man during an attempt to arrest him.

Trump Sharpens Threat As Clashes With Agents Continue in Minnesota

**Tacitly Backing ICE’s
Aggressive Tactics**

**Says Insurrection Act
Could Be Invoked**

By HAMED ALEAZIZ and NICHOLAS NEHAMAS

WASHINGTON — The instructions to Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents explain in clear terms how to defuse dangerous encounters: Use “minimal force” when trying to remove people from cars. Issue commands in “professional,” “firm,” “courteous” voices.

“First step in arresting an occupant of a vehicle is NOT to reach in and grab him, unless there are specific circumstances requiring that action,” reads one internal ICE document providing legal guidance for uses of force during vehicle stops. It was reviewed by The New York Times, along with other training materials. ICE officials will thoroughly investigate any encounter, but “deadly force” is allowed only when agents believe lives are in danger.

The fatal shooting of Renee Good last week by an ICE agent in Minneapolis — and the quick reaction by Trump administration officials to declare the agent a hero and Ms. Good a villain — has put a new focus on whether federal agents enforcing President Trump’s deportation drive have been properly prepared for confrontations on city streets. The response of Mr. Trump and his top lieutenants to the killing has also underscored how they have embraced what is supposed to be a last resort under the written standards: using lethal force in self-defense.

Rather than encourage agents to de-escalate combustible encounters, as the agency guidelines emphasize, Mr. Trump and his lieutenants have provided tacit approval for more aggressive tactics.

Several weeks before the shooting, a top ICE official told officers to take “decisive action” if threatened. Immediately after, Mr.

Continued on Page A15

‘No’ From U.S. Crypto Colossus Was Enough to Halt Senate Vote

By DAVID YAFFE-BELLANY

A major cryptocurrency bill was headed for a committee vote in the Senate on Thursday after months of negotiations, a crucial step in the legislative process.

Then came a social media post from the top executive of Coinbase, the largest U.S. crypto company.

“Coinbase unfortunately can’t support the bill as written,” Brian Armstrong, chief executive of Coinbase, posted on X on Wednesday evening. “This version would be materially worse than the current status quo. We’d rather have no bill than a bad bill.”

Within hours, the Senate vote was canceled.

The fate of a hotly contested legislative vote typically hinges on a few key lawmakers who are the moderate voices in a partisan scuffle. But what happened this week to the landmark crypto bill shows how much power Coinbase now wields in Washington, with the crypto industry newly ascendant under President Trump.

Setback to Bill Shows Clout of Coinbase in Washington

For months, congressional staff members had worked on the Clarity Act, a nearly 300-page bill designed to establish a regulatory framework for virtually every aspect of crypto, with rules the industry helped write. But at the last minute, Mr. Armstrong objected to proposed language that threatened to outlaw one of Coinbase’s products and said the bill would assign too much authority to the Securities and Exchange Commission, the nation’s top financial regulator.

Coinbase’s decisive intervention follows years of the company’s work to build a voice in Washington. A publicly traded firm worth nearly \$70 billion, Coinbase helped finance a network of political action committees that spent

Continued on Page A18

Initial Inquiry Finds No Evidence Of Broad Migrant Voting Fraud

By ALEXANDRA BERZON and NICK CORASANITI

It was a common refrain for Donald J. Trump and his allies during the 2024 campaign: The Biden administration was purposely encouraging mass numbers of immigrants to cross the border in order to vote illegally.

As president, Mr. Trump has pushed his administration to address the alleged crimes, including prompting many states to upload tens of millions of voter records to a federal immigration verification tool run out of the Department of Homeland Security.

But with the review underway, the results so far indicate there is no evidence of widespread fraud, according to interviews with government officials and documents reviewed by The New York Times.

Out of 49.5 million voter registrations that have been checked, the department referred around 10,000 cases to Homeland Security Investigations for further investigation of noncitizenship, or 0.02 percent of the names processed, according to Matthew Tragesser, a spokesman for U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services, the D.H.S. agency that oversees the program. A Justice Department spokeswoman also said the administration believed that around 10,000 registered non-citizen voters had been found.

They did not specify how many of those people had voted.

Even that number could be inflated. The verification tool has mistakenly flagged some people who appear to actually be citizens, according to some local election officials.

In Charlotte County, Fla., for instance, the elections supervisor, Leah Valenti, an appointee of Ron DeSantis, the Republican governor, said she found that just 15 out

Continued on Page A17

Contradicting Familiar Refrain of President and His Allies

More From the White House

FENTANYL WAR The U.S. is again pressuring Mexico to let its military help combat cartels. **PAGE A7**

ETHICS Traders with ties to the president’s eldest son wager on real-world events. **PAGE A17**

THE BRAND In a self-referential year, the president has broken with norms on naming. **PAGE A11**

HOUSING Fannie Mae and Freddie Mac pull back from helping people buy homes. **PAGE B1**

In Bitter Winter Freeze, Russia Focuses on Wiping Out the Heat

By ANDREW E. KRAMER

KYIV, Ukraine — They lived in a comfortable, spacious apartment in a fashionable neighborhood of Kyiv, what they called “our little fortress” through years of war. Even after it was damaged in a missile strike, they stayed put in the Ukrainian capital, renting another apartment.

But this week, Russian drone and missile strikes left Kyiv in the grip of its worst heating and electricity outage of the war. The couple, Yulia Mykhailiuk, a lawyer, and Ihor Honcharuk, a TV station manager, could see their breath indoors as temperatures outside peaked around 12 degrees Fahrenheit. Mr. Honcharuk jury-rigged a heater by placing a brick over a gas burner on the stove, to little avail. They had had enough.

They bundled their 1-year-old son in a car and abandoned Kyiv for a relative’s home in a village.

“I don’t want to say this is

Continued on Page A8



Ukrainians in one of the parked train cars around Kyiv that have heat and power during blackouts.

Nobel Peace Laureate’s Wooing Of Trump Annoys Norwegians

By MAX BEARAK and HENRIK PRYSER LIBELL

Maria Corina Machado, Venezuela’s opposition leader and last year’s Nobel Peace Prize winner, said on Thursday after dining with President Trump at the White House that she had presented him with “the medal of the Nobel Peace Prize.”

It was not immediately clear whether Mr. Trump had accepted the prize from her, but he has made it clear how he feels about the Peace Prize going to Ms. Machado and not to him.

“I single-handedly ENDED 8 WARS, and Norway, a NATO Member, foolishly chose not to give me the Noble Peace Prize,” he said on social media last week. Beyond misspelling the award’s name, he attributed the decision to the entire country of Norway rather than the five-member committee that makes its choices independently of the government.

Ms. Machado has repeatedly sought to curry favor with Mr. Trump by proposing to share the



Maria Corina Machado leaving the White House on Thursday.

award with him. She has cheered the U.S. military’s capture of Venezuela’s president, Nicolás Maduro, and remained mum about a bombing campaign against boats Mr. Trump says are smuggling drugs. The American strikes have killed more than 100 people.

Speaking to supporters and reporters in Washington, Ms. Machado said she was “impressed”

Continued on Page A6

NATIONAL A11-19, 22

Raising New Life After Fire
They brought a baby into the world, then everything changed. An Altadena family’s journey to peace. **PAGE A12**

Astronauts Are Safely on Earth
The members of Crew-11 splashed down after one became ill, prompting an early return from the space station. **PAGE A18**



INTERNATIONAL A4-10

China’s Coal Ban Creates Woes
The government’s clean air campaign and its heavy-handed enforcement has left many villagers near Beijing unable to afford heat this winter. **PAGE A4**

Execution Threat Walked Back
After global outcry, Iran’s judiciary said there was no death penalty issued for a protester. Experts say fear is being used to keep people off the streets. **PAGE A9**

All Eyes on Judge’s Stamina
Judge Alvin K. Hellerstein was seen drifting in and out of sleep in court last year. The case of Nicolás Maduro will be a test of his endurance. **PAGE A7**

BUSINESS B1-5

The Year of the Mega I.P.O.?
If valuable high-profile companies like SpaceX, OpenAI and Anthropic go public this year as expected, they will unleash gushers of cash for Silicon Valley and Wall Street. **PAGE B1**

X Restricts Grok’s Images
Bowing to outside pressure, Elon Musk’s company said it would block X users from generating explicit images of real people in jurisdictions where such content is illegal. **PAGE B5**

OPINION A20-21

Michelle Cottle **PAGE 21**

SPORTS B6-9, B12

Far-Range Gambling Scheme
Federal prosecutors have charged 26 men with alleged conspiracy to manipulate college basketball games. **PAGE B12**

Baseball Player Incapacitated
An Angels prospect sustained a traumatic brain injury as the passenger of an impaired driver. **PAGE B6**



WEEKEND ARTS C1-10

Picturing Dachau’s Horrors
When Brian Stonehouse, a British spy, was freed from the Nazi concentration camp, he made drawings to document what he had witnessed. Four of those images are now up for sale. **PAGE C1**

No End to These Zombies
The latest installment in the “28 Years Later” saga is all about good and evil, and whether any of it exists. And, of course, about putting a lot of blood and gore onto the screen. **PAGE C1**

